



CGD6224 – Game Design Fundamentals

Trimester March 2026

## Assignment 3 (20%)

# Game Concept & Level Design

### 1. Introduction

Games are powerful systems that explore different forms of **connection** – between players and the game world, between characters, between mechanics, or even between players themselves. **Connection** can be emotional, mechanical, spatial, social, or conceptual.

In game design, connection is often expressed through :

- Interacting systems that depend on each other
- Player choices that affect the environment or characters
- Relationships between characters, objects, or players
- Cause-and-effect mechanics that reward understanding and mastery

In this assignment, students will work in groups to design a simple digital game concept based on the theme of “**Connection**”, which will be developed later using G-Develop. The focus of this assignment is **game design, level design, and player experience**, not technical implementation.

## 2. Assignment Objectives

Your objectives are to :

### **Group Objectives**

1. Design a simple digital game concept based on the theme “**Connection**”, suitable for development using G-Develop.
2. Design at least two levels or gameplay phases, where:
  - ❖ Each level introduces a new form of connection, or
  - ❖ The same connection mechanic is expanded or made more challenging.
3. Clearly define :
  - ❖ Core mechanics
  - ❖ Player objectives
  - ❖ Rules and constraints
  - ❖ Win and lose conditions
4. Demonstrate how the game creates **meaningful connections**, such as
  - ❖ Player ↔ Environment
  - ❖ Object ↔ Object
  - ❖ Character ↔ Character
  - ❖ Player ↔ Player (Optional)
5. Submit your **Deliverables** to eBwise before the **Deadline**.

### **Individual Task**

1. Each student must select 2 games presented by other groups and write feedbacks analysis on that game.
2. The structured feedback analysis should be covering :
  - ❖ Core mechanics
  - ❖ Use of the “**Connection**” theme
  - ❖ Level design and progression
  - ❖ Clarity of rules and objectives
  - ❖ Constructive suggestions for improvement (Optional)

### 3. Theme Interpretation: “Connection”

Groups may interpret the theme creatively. Examples include (but are not limited to) :

- ❖ **Physical Connection**  
(e.g linking objects, cables, bridges, chains)
- ❖ **Emotional or Narrative Connection**  
(e.g helping characters, rebuilding relationships)
- ❖ **System Connection**  
(e.g switches that affect multiple systems, cause-and-affect chains)
- ❖ **Spatial Connection**  
(e.g portals, paths, synchronized movement)
- ❖ **Social Connection**  
(e.g cooperation, turn-based interaction, shared goals)

### 4. Deadline

Before **Week 10, 7<sup>th</sup> June 2026 (Sunday), 11:59pm.**

### 5. Grouping

To be done in a group of 3-4 students.

### 6. Deliverables

#### **Group Task Deliverables**

Each group must submit a **Game Design Folder** containing the following:

#### **1. Game Design Document (GDD)**

The GDD should be covering:

- ❖ Game title and theme interpretation
- ❖ Target platform (PC)
- ❖ Core gameplay concept
- ❖ Core mechanics of the game
- ❖ Player controls (e.g. using WASD or mouse control)
- ❖ Winning and losing conditions
- ❖ Explanation of how “Connection” is expressed in gameplay
- ❖ UI & Screen Mockups (either hand drawn or digital design is acceptable)
  - Gameplay Screen
  - Win / Lose Screen

## **Individual Task Deliverables**

### **1. Feedback**

Everyone needs to submit 2 feedback analysis, 1 for each chosen game.

## **7. Submission Instructions**

All deliverables are to be submitted online via eBwise. Late submission or submission via email shall not be accepted.

Do follow the instructions below to prepare your submissions. Marks will be deducted for failing to follow any of the instructions below :

### Group Task Submission

1. Place all group deliverables into one folder.
2. Compress and name the file using the short names of every group member (in Pascal case) separated by hyphens (e.g. MohammadAli-ChongWei-SivaKumar).
3. Once you have ensured the ZIP/RAR file contains the finalized deliverables, submit the file to eBwise.

### Individual Task Submission

1. Put both feedback analysis together into a folder and put you name as the name of the folder. (eg. MohammadAli, SivaKumar, JohnWick)

2. Compress the file into a RAR/ZIP file and make sure the name remains the same.
3. Submit the file into the correct section in eBwise.

## 8. Presentation

The presentation session will be held on **Week 10 tutorial session, 4th June 2026**. Each group will be given 10 minutes to present their gameplay.

## 6. Plagiarism

It is normal to seek help from friends or from online resources when you do the assignment. However, seeking help should not go overboard, to the point of getting (or even paying) someone to complete the assignment partly or fully for you, copying from online resources without understanding or doing any means with the intention to cheat.

For this assignment, plagiarism means the following:

1. Turning in a work that, from the examiner`s point of view, you do not understand sufficiently.
2. Turning in someone else's (including AI agent's) work, whether partly or fully, as your own.
3. To use another's work, whether partly or fully, without crediting the source.
4. Any means of cheating.

**Plagiarism is a serious offence. ZERO (0) marks will be given to students who plagiarize AND to students who intentionally or unintentionally help other students to plagiarize by giving all or some of their work.**

## 8. Evaluation Criteria

### Task #1: The Game

|                                | <b>Creativity of Core Mechanics</b>                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2 - Exceeding</b>           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Mechanics are highly original, clearly centered on the theme of “Connection”, and demonstrate innovative thinking.</li> </ul> |
| <b>1.5 - Proficient</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Mechanics are creative and meaningful, with a clear relationship to the theme.</li> </ul>                                     |
| <b>1 - Basic</b>               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Mechanics show some creativity but are generic or weakly linked to the theme.</li> </ul>                                      |
| <b>0.5 – Needs Improvement</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Mechanics are unoriginal or unrelated to the theme.</li> </ul>                                                                |

|                                | <b>Level Design &amp; Progression</b>                                                                                                |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>2 - Exceeding</b>           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Levels are thoughtfully designed with strong progression and evolving connections.</li> </ul> |
| <b>1.5 - Proficient</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Levels show clear progression and logical challenge scaling.</li> </ul>                       |
| <b>1 - Basic</b>               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Levels exist, but progression is minimal or unclear.</li> </ul>                               |
| <b>0.5 – Needs Improvement</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Levels lack structure or meaningful progression.</li> </ul>                                   |

|                       | <b>Use of Theme: “Connection”</b>                                                                                               |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>4 - Exceeding</b>  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The theme is deeply integrated into mechanics, levels, and player experience.</li> </ul> |
| <b>3 - Proficient</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The theme is clearly present and consistently applied.</li> </ul>                        |
| <b>2 - Basic</b>      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The theme is mentioned but weakly expressed in gameplay.</li> </ul>                      |

|                              |                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                              |                                                                                                         |
| <b>1 – Needs Improvement</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The theme is unclear or disconnected from the design.</li> </ul> |

|                              |                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                              | <b>Overall Completeness and Playability</b>                                                                        |
| <b>4 - Exceeding</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Design is complete, polished, and clearly feasible in G-Develop.</li> </ul> |
| <b>3 - Proficient</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Design is mostly complete and feasible with minor gaps.</li> </ul>          |
| <b>2 - Basic</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Design lacks detail or feasibility explanation.</li> </ul>                  |
| <b>1 – Needs Improvement</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Design is incomplete or unrealistic.</li> </ul>                             |

#### Task #2: The Feedback

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                              | <b>Peer Evaluation</b>                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>4 - Exceeding</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provided highly insightful, critical analysis and constructive feedback for the chosen game, offering actionable insights for improvement.</li> </ul>                  |
| <b>3 - Proficient</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Offered constructive feedback with some critical analysis, identifying strengths and weaknesses of the chosen game, and suggesting actionable improvements.</li> </ul> |
| <b>2 - Basic</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Feedback provided was somewhat critical and constructive but lacked depth or specificity, requiring further elaboration to be actionable.</li> </ul>                   |
| <b>1 – Needs Improvement</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Feedback lacked sufficient critical analysis or constructive insights, offering little to no actionable feedback for the chosen game to work on.</li> </ul>            |

|                              | <b>Analysis of Strength and Weaknesses</b>                                                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>4 - Exceeding</b>         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Clearly identifies multiple strengths and explains why they are effective.</li> <li>Identify weaknesses with clear reasoning. (confusing rules, imbalance etc)</li> </ul> |
| <b>3 - Proficient</b>        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Identifies strengths and weaknesses, but explanation lacks depth.</li> </ul>                                                                                              |
| <b>2 - Basic</b>             | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>List strengths and weaknesses with little or no explanation.</li> </ul>                                                                                                   |
| <b>1 – Needs Improvement</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Fails to identify meaningful strengths and weaknesses.</li> </ul>                                                                                                         |

|                  | <b>Plagiarism</b>               |      |
|------------------|---------------------------------|------|
| <b>Penalties</b> | 0 = No<br>1 = Yes               | / 1  |
|                  | Total = 20 x ( 1 – Plagiarism ) | / 20 |